

Learn the system. Improve with evidence.

Hypotheses for discovery—not a prescription written without Cresta's internal context.

The first ninety days should earn the right to improve the system: observe how value currently moves, test one useful review pattern, then make proven learning reusable.

OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Listen first

Learn the current delivery system from the people running it.

Protect momentum

Add clarity where it reduces delay; avoid process theater.

Use live work

Test hypotheses against actual deployment decisions.

Leave signal

Make each engagement improve the next decision.

THREE HORIZONS

Days 1–30

Learn the deployment system.

Observe handoffs, decision rights, product rhythms, customer pressures, and the signals the team already trusts.

Output: shared view of where value stalls

Days 31–60

Prove the Activation Review.

Apply the four-condition model to live work and test whether it creates earlier decisions.

Output: one review pattern worth repeating

Days 61–90

Make learning reusable.

Propose portfolio health signals and a feedback path across delivery, product, success, and GTM.

Output: clearer intervention and expansion decisions

QUESTIONS THAT GOVERN THE ENTRY

Customer boundary

- What do customers mean by ready, adopted, safe, and valuable?
- Where does decision latency create more risk than technical complexity?
- Which adoption signals predict business movement?

Internal boundary

- How do Deployment, FDE, Product, Success, Value, and GTM divide ownership?
- Which learning is reusable and which must remain customer-specific?
- Where does Conductor change the deployment bottleneck?

RESTRAINT

No premature redesign.

The plan does not assume Cresta lacks a deployment system. It proposes a disciplined way to learn the existing one, contribute to live delivery, and test improvements with the team's guidance.

01 Days 1–30 · Learn the deployment system

OBSERVE BEFORE ALTERING

WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	EVIDENCE / OUTPUT
Customer reality	Shadow discovery, kickoff, implementation, readiness, enablement, go-live, and optimization moments across representative work.	Vocabulary map: what different stakeholders mean by ready, adopted, valuable, and done.
Decision rights	Map where the customer, Deployment, FDE, Product, Success, Value, and GTM decide, advise, approve, or escalate.	Decision map with ambiguity and latency hotspots.
Delivery signals	Learn the dashboards, milestones, evaluation thresholds, customer metrics, risks, and review cadences the team already trusts.	Signal inventory; no new metric until its decision use is clear.
Product fluency	Build working knowledge of AI Agent, Agent Assist, Conversation Intelligence, Conductor, testing, and optimization workflows.	Ability to explain value, dependencies, limits, and handoffs plainly.
Team trust	Ask where a new deployment manager can remove friction without creating extra reporting or bypassing expertise.	Written personal operating agreement with manager and key partners.

Day-30 restraint

Do not present an “improved process” after a month. Present observed patterns, questions, and one bounded hypothesis the team agrees is worth testing.

02 Days 31–60 · Prove the Activation Review

USE LIVE WORK, NOT A
WORKSHOP TOY

WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	EVIDENCE / OUTPUT
Select	With team guidance, choose one live deployment decision where outcome, readiness, adoption, or evidence is meaningfully uncertain.	A real decision with a named owner and time horizon.
Frame	Run a short Activation Review: define the intended outcome, weakest condition, ownership gap, and evidence required.	One-page review; no duplicate project plan.
Act	Facilitate the next decision, remove or escalate a dependency, and make the customer-facing consequence explicit.	Decision latency, owner clarity, and follow-through observed.
Validate	Ask participants whether the review improved the decision enough to justify repeating or simplifying it.	Keep, change, or stop decision with direct feedback.

Day-60 restraint

A neat artifact is not success. Repeat only if the review creates earlier clarity, cleaner ownership, or better evidence without slowing delivery.

03

Days 61–90 · Make proven learning reusable

SCALE JUDGMENT, NOT
BUREAUCRACY

WORKSTREAM	ACTIONS	EVIDENCE / OUTPUT
Pattern	Compare the tested review against other deployment contexts. Separate a reusable decision pattern from customer-specific detail.	A small pattern library with explicit limits.
Portfolio health	Propose the minimum leading indicators that reveal stalled outcomes, aging dependencies, weak adoption, or missing evidence.	A reviewable signal set tied to intervention decisions.
Feedback path	Clarify how implementation learning should reach Product, Engineering, Customer Success, Value, and GTM.	Closed-loop handoff with owner and response expectation.
Customer scale	Use outcome evidence and readiness to frame the next optimization or expansion conversation.	Scale decision grounded in customer value, not enthusiasm alone.
Personal review	Request direct feedback on delivery presence, technical learning, customer trust, judgment, and operating contribution.	Next-quarter development and contribution commitments.

Day-90 restraint

Do not standardize what has only worked once. Preserve exceptions that reveal meaningful customer risk or value.

PROPOSED OPERATING CADENCE / SUBJECT TO DISCOVERY

Weekly

Portfolio exceptions, decisions due, adoption risks, and customer confidence.

At release

Outcome, readiness, adoption owner, evidence threshold, and intervention rule.

Post-launch

Business delta, experience signal, model performance, learning, and next decision.

DAY-90 SCORECARD

Customer trust	Can sponsors and operators explain what changed and what comes next?	Evidence: direct feedback and decision follow-through
Delivery contribution	Did Russell help live work move with greater clarity?	Evidence: resolved dependencies and useful decisions
Technical fluency	Can Russell guide the deployment without hand-waving limits or risk?	Evidence: team feedback and customer conversations
Reusable learning	Did one verified pattern or signal improve more than one decision?	Evidence: voluntary reuse with bounded scope
Next-quarter leverage	Is the next contribution clear to manager and partners?	Evidence: agreed priorities and development plan